Applied Materials Inc. (AMAT): Investor meeting highlights stronger WFE market opportunities plus higher long-term margin targets

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Key stock takeaways: We attended Applied's Investor Breakfast at SEMICON West and EPIC Center unveiling on Oct. 12-13, and came away incrementally positive on Applied's path to substantially higher long-term earnings power. We believe the stock's reaction (down 7% amid a sector-wide selloff) may have reflected some level of disappointment given the lack of a specific medium-term WFE forecast and earnings target (prior to 2030). However, we believe the stock is likely to recover as we believe the upcoming earnings season will validate our view that Applied's earnings power is likely to be significantly higher by 2028, given outsized WFE market growth and its outsized exposure to deposition and etch.

Key takeaways include:

- **Long-term WFE outlook:** Applied sees Agentic AI and Physical AI accelerating WFE growth through CY30, with AI factory pods driving 2-4X greater wafer demand. Roughly 75% of WFE growth is expected to come from leading-edge logic, DRAM, and advanced packaging, areas where Applied holds leadership positions and is gaining share in served markets. With ~55% WFE SAM exposure, Applied targets ~300bps of SAM share gain in foundry/logic and ~500bps in DRAM - translating to ~200bps of overall WFE share gain. To support this growth, Applied plans to more than double its manufacturing and lab capacity while reducing CapEx intensity.
- **Financial targets:** Applied targets gross margin of ~54% and operating margin of ~40% by CY30, supported by ~500bps of gross margin expansion and ~1000bps of operating leverage. Applied expects $15B in services revenue (mid-teens growth) and $2B in Other revenue by CY30, with 80%-100% of FCF returned to shareholders over time. We view these targets as very constructive, but recognize that the long-dated CY30 timeline have fallen short of investor expectations.
- **AGS momentum:** AGS revenue is set to grow 20% this year and mid-teens thereafter, supported by both installed-base growth and rising service intensity. AI^{x}-connected chambers are expected to scale from >37K today to >90K by CY30, helping drive 20% higher service revenue per tool through predictive maintenance, yield optimization, and 30% faster service resolution. Importantly, the model carries strong visibility, with >2.5-year average subscription agreements and ~90% renewal rates.

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- **Advanced packaging & inspection:** Applied sees ~2X packaging SAM expansion from hybrid bonding in HBM, targeting ~60% HBM packaging share and >$5B in annual advanced packaging revenue. Rising packaging complexity is also increasing the value of inspection, supporting >50% process control/inspection growth in CY26.
- **EPIC Center unveiling:** Applied's new $5B, 600K-square-foot EPIC Center aims to accelerate collaboration between Applied and a wide range of customers through co-innovation. EPIC targets up to 2X faster chip development as AI drives 1.5x more leading-edge process steps and 70% higher semiconductor R&D.

Price target and risks: Our 12-month price target of $670 is based on a 32X P/E multiple applied to our normalized EPS estimate of $21.00. Key downside risks include: (1) incremental export restrictions; (2) local China-based supplier share gains.

AMAT	12m Price Target: **$670.00**	Price: **$464.24**	Upside: **44.3%**

Buy CL

Market cap: $370.9bn
Enterprise value: $369.3bn
3m ADTV: $3.4bn
United States
Americas Semiconductors & IT Services
M&A Rank: 3

GS Forecast

	10/25	10/26E	10/27E	10/28E
Revenue ($ mn)	28,368.0	34,545.9	50,168.9	62,358.9
EBITDA ($ mn)	8,997.0	11,973.8	18,408.7	23,192.3
EBIT ($ mn)	8,562.0	11,450.8	17,968.7	22,752.3
EPS ($)	9.42	12.87	19.76	25.01
P/E (X)	18.6	36.1	23.5	18.6
EV/EBITDA (X)	15.6	30.6	19.7	15.2
FCF yield (%)	4.0	1.5	3.2	4.4
Dividend yield (%)	1.0	0.4	0.5	0.6
Net debt/EBITDA (X)	(0.1)	(0.1)	(0.3)	(0.5)

	7/26	10/26E	1/27E	4/27E
EPS ($)	3.49	4.14	4.21	4.71

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 13 Oct 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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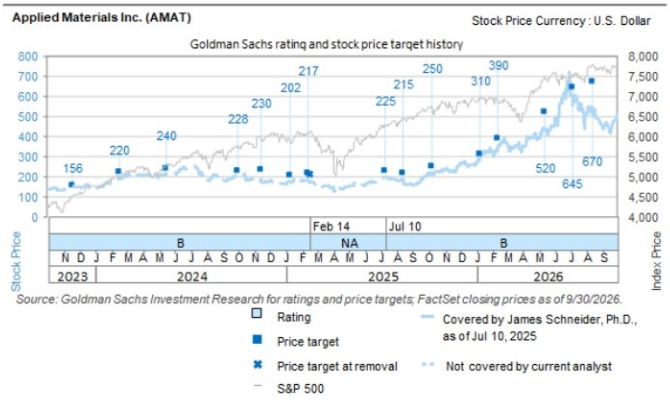
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Target price history table(s)

Applied Materials Inc. (AMAT)

Date of report	Target price ($)	Closing price ($)
13-Aug-26	670.00	534.54
05-Jul-26	645.00	603.04
15-May-26	520.00	436.62
13-Feb-26	390.00	354.91
09-Jan-26	310.00	301.18
08-Oct-25	250.00	217.51
15-Aug-25	215.00	161.76
10-Jul-25	225.00	198.03
10-Jan-25	202.00	171.65
15-Nov-24	230.00	168.88
02-Oct-24	228.00	201.15
17-May-24	240.00	212.08
16-Feb-24	220.00	199.57
17-Nov-23	156.00	148.59

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